READ FIRST

When plans change

Read the extract. Discuss the questions with a partner and use details from the text.

The situation: Fiona has just received her Assignment. Jonas expects his turn next. He belongs to the Elevens and is about to become a Twelve. **Nineteen is his birth and ceremony number, not his age.**

LOIS LOWRY, THE GIVER | CHAPTER 7, PRINTED PAGE 57

Jonas prepared himself to walk to the stage when the applause ended and the Chief Elder picked up the next folder and looked down to the group to call forward the next new Twelve. He was calm now that his turn had come. He took a deep breath and smoothed his hair with his hand.

"Twenty," he heard her voice say clearly. "Pierre." She skipped me, Jonas thought, stunned. Had he heard wrong? No. There was a sudden hush in the crowd, and he knew that the entire community realized that the Chief Elder had moved from Eighteen to Twenty, leaving a gap. On his right, Pierre, with a startled look, rose from his seat and moved to the stage.

A mistake. She made a mistake. But Jonas knew, even as he had the thought, that she hadn't. The Chief Elder made no mistakes. Not at the Ceremony of Twelve.

He felt dizzy, and couldn't focus his attention. He didn't hear what Assignment Pierre received, and was only dimly aware of the applause as the boy returned, wearing his new badge. Then: Twenty-one. Twenty-two.

The numbers continued in order. Jonas sat, dazed, as they moved into the Thirties and then the Forties, nearing the end. Each time, at each announcement, his heart jumped for a moment, and he thought wild thoughts. Perhaps now she would call his name. Could he have forgotten his own number? No. He had always been Nineteen. He was sitting in the seat marked Nineteen.

But she had skipped him.

1 Understand the moment

1. What is Jonas preparing to do? Which actions show that he expects his turn?

2. What happens instead, and how does it interrupt his intended action?

3. How do his feelings change? Does he stop hoping that his name will be called?

THINK BEFORE THE RULE

Discover the pattern

Talk through each step and explain your choices to a partner.

2 Freeze the story

> “Perhaps now she would call his name.”

1. At the moment of this thought, has the Chief Elder called Jonas’s name?

2. Is being called before this thought, or still in Jonas’s future?

3. The story is told in the past. Which two words look forward from that past moment?

3 Compare an expectation and an intention

A. Jonas thought she **would call** his number next.

B. He **was going to walk** onto the stage, but she called Pierre.

These two sentences are classroom paraphrases based on the scene, not quotations from the novel.

1. Which sentence describes what Jonas believed would happen? Which describes what he intended to do?

2. In sentence B, which words tell us that his intended next action was interrupted?

3. What form of the verb follows **would**? What form follows **was going to**? Compare call with called, and walk with walking.

4 Say the rule before you check

Explain these patterns to your partner. Choose the words that fit.

Time: From a past point of view, these expressions look **forward / backward**.

Expectation: would + **V1 / past form / -ing form**

Intention: was / were going to + **V1 / past form / -ing form**

Then turn the page to check your discovery and revisit the scene through the cartoons.

CHECK, THEN EXPLAIN

Return to Jonas

Compare your discovery with the rule. Then use it to explain the cartoon sequence.

Future in the Past: we look forward from an earlier moment.
would + V1 can report an earlier expectation.
was / were going to + V1 can describe an earlier intention.

The form alone does not tell us whether the later action happened. Here, the rest of the story shows that Jonas's intended next action was interrupted.

Look at panels 1–3. Explain what Jonas expected, what interrupted his intention, and what he still hoped would happen.



Panel 4: an imagined conversation

Fiona: What did you think would happen?
Jonas: I thought she would call my number. I was going to walk onto the stage, but she called Pierre.

The illustrations and conversation are classroom adaptations. This exchange does not appear in the novel.

SCENE O | 1 OF 5

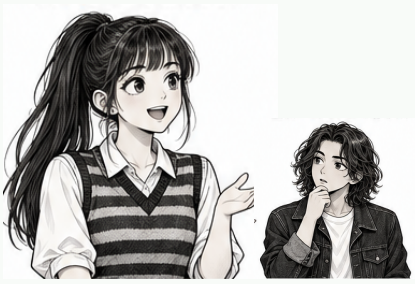
Expectations

Read the cartoon in order. Explain why the form fits this situation.

Jonas thought his number would be called. At the fair, Rüzgâr also explains what he expected before an event.

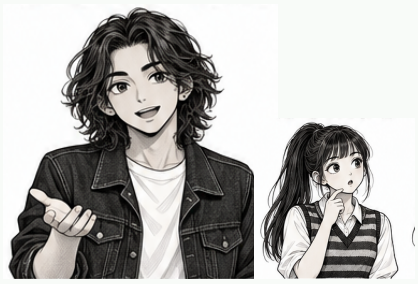
01 EYLÜL

Why did you bring extra money to the fair?



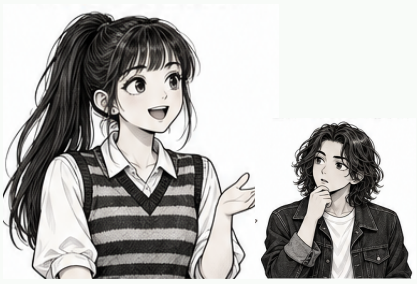
02 RÜZGÂR

I thought the snacks would be expensive.



03 EYLÜL

So you expected higher prices before you arrived.



Make the connection

Notice: I thought the snacks **would be** expensive.
Form: would + V1

Meaning: His thought about prices came first. Buying snacks was still ahead from that earlier point of view.

Think: Which happened first: his expectation about prices or his visit to the fair?

Use it aloud: Explain something you expected before a school event: “I thought … would …”.

SCENE M | 2 OF 5

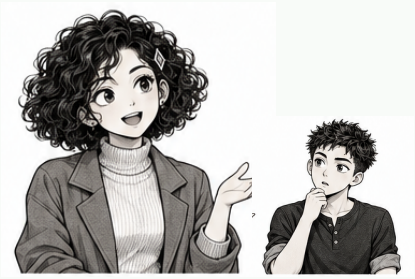
Intentions

Read the cartoon in order. Explain why the form fits this situation.

Jonas was preparing to walk onto the stage. Now compare that interrupted intention with a shopping plan that changed.

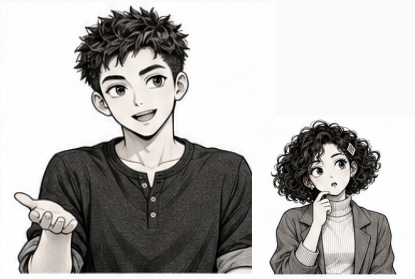
01 CEREN

Did you buy new headphones?



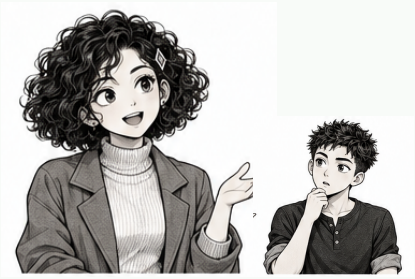
02 BARAN

No. I was going to buy them, but I repaired my old pair.



03 CEREN

So your plan changed.



Make the connection

Notice: I **was going to buy** them, but I repaired my old pair.
Form: was / were going to + V1

Meaning: Buying headphones was Baran’s earlier intention. The words after “but” explain what he did instead.

Think: Did Baran buy the new headphones? Which words show the outcome?

Use it aloud: Tell your partner about a real or invented plan that changed: “I was going to …, but …”.

SCENE N | 3 OF 5

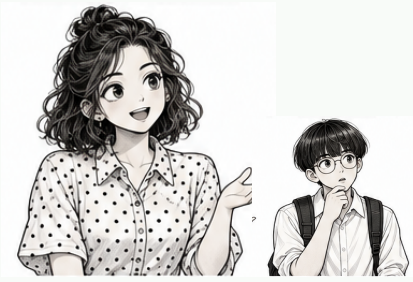
Predictions

Read the cartoon in order. Explain why the form fits this situation.

The same form can describe a prediction. Compare an intention to buy something with expecting rain from dark clouds.

01 DERIN

Why did you take an umbrella yesterday?



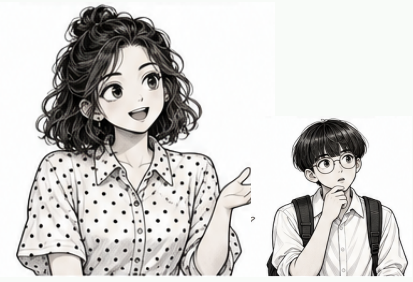
02 KUZEY

The sky was dark. I thought it was going to rain.



03 DERIN

So you expected rain before you left.



Make the connection

Notice: I thought it **was going to rain**.
Form: was / were going to + V1

Meaning: Kuzey saw dark clouds and predicted rain. He was not planning to make it rain. His prediction was made before he left home.

Think: What evidence supported his prediction? Does this dialogue tell us whether it actually rained?

Use it aloud: Explain why you took a coat or umbrella one day: “I thought it was going to …, so I …”.

SCENE P | 4 OF 5

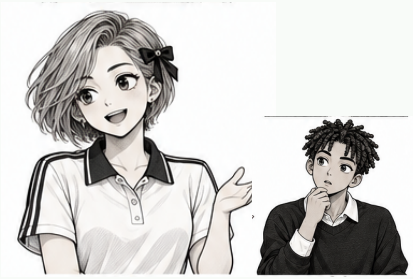
Arrangements

Read the cartoon in order. Explain why the form fits this situation.

An intention is one kind of future plan. A meeting already agreed with another person is an arrangement. Rewind to Monday and look ahead to Friday.

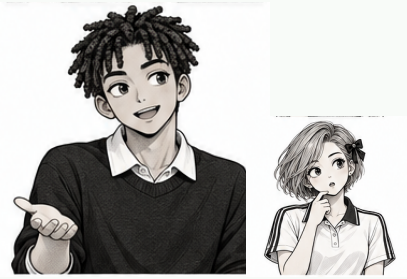
01 YASMIN

Why were you so busy last Monday?



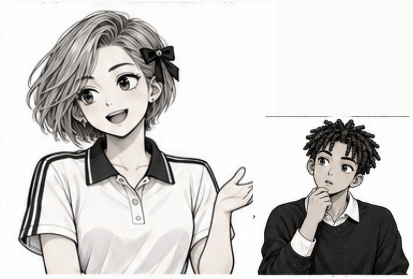
02 TOPRAK

We were meeting the charity organiser on Friday, so we had to prepare.



03 YASMIN

The meeting was already arranged, then.



Make the connection

Notice: We **were meeting** the charity organiser on Friday.
Form: was / were + V-ing

Meaning: From the point of view of Monday, the agreed Friday meeting was still in the future. The time clues make the arrangement clear.

Think: Had Friday happened yet on Monday? Was “meeting” an action in progress on Monday or an arrangement for later?

Use it aloud: Look back at Monday and explain a Friday arrangement: “We were meeting … on Friday, so …”.

SCENE Q | 5 OF 5

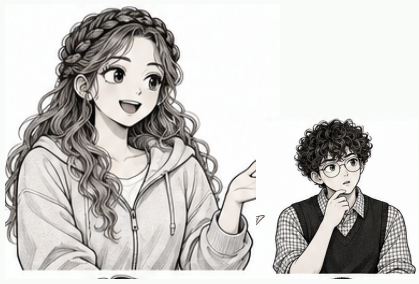
Responsibilities

Read the cartoon in order. Explain why the form fits this situation.

A plan tells us what someone intended to do. A responsibility tells us what was expected of them. Compare “going to help” with “supposed to help”.

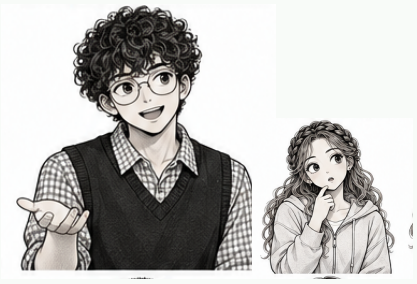
01 ELA

Why was the teacher looking for our team?



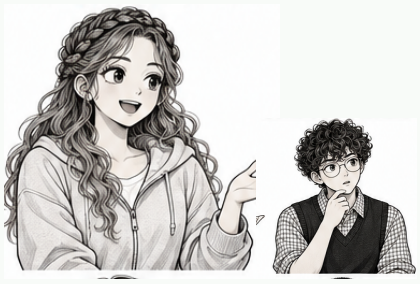
02 TUNA

We were supposed to set up the tables before lunch, but we were late.



03 ELA

So that was our job.



Make the connection

Notice: We **were supposed to set up** the tables before lunch.
Form: was / were supposed to + V1

Meaning: Setting up the tables before lunch was the team’s agreed responsibility. The rest of the sentence explains that they were late.

Think: Does “supposed to” describe what the team wanted, or the job expected of them? What went wrong?

Use it aloud: Describe an agreed job and what actually happened: “We were supposed to …, but …”.

BRING THE MEANINGS TOGETHER

Compare before you choose

Look back across the cartoons. Say what each form means before choosing it.

V1: the form in **call, buy, rain, walk** and **set up**.
V-ing: the form in **meeting** and **helping**.

Earlier expectation: would + V1

Earlier intention: was / were going to + V1

Earlier prediction: was / were going to + V1

Later arrangement in a past story: was / were + V-ing

Earlier responsibility: was / were supposed to + V1

Return to Jonas: explain his expectation and interrupted intention using two different forms. Then choose one of the other scenes and explain how its meaning is different.

Talk it through

1. Which two cartoon scenes use **was / were going to + V1** for different meanings? Explain the difference.

2. How is an arrangement different from an intention? Use the Friday meeting to explain.

3. How is a responsibility different from a personal plan? Use the tables before lunch to explain.

Keep the outcome separate: these forms look forward from a past moment. Use the rest of the story to work out what actually happened.